



MODDABLE CHESS

VARIANT LIBRARY

Every game is a new challenge

73

VARIANTS

2-6

PLAYERS

10+

AGE

Published by Moddable Games · v0.4.4 · Printed 23 June 2026

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Moddable Chess includes 73 playable variants spanning classic rules, asymmetric battles, hidden information, expanded boards, and alternative win conditions. Each variant has its own complete rules page.

STANDARD BOARD (8×8)

- ♦ [Standard Chess](#) — Classic FIDE rules
- ♦ [Absorption Chess](#) — Capturing piece gains the victim's movement permanently
- ♦ [Andernach Chess](#) — Capturing piece changes colour
- ♦ [Atomic](#) — Captures explode adjacent pieces
- ♦ [Benedict Chess](#) — Attacked enemies convert colour
- ♦ [Berserk Chess](#) — Check grants a bonus move
- ♦ [Checkless Chess](#) — No check unless it is checkmate
- ♦ [Crazyhouse](#) — Captured pieces switch sides and drop back onto the board
- ♦ [Cylinder Chess](#) — Files wrap, a-file connects to h-file
- ♦ [Dark Chess](#) — Only see squares your pieces occupy
- ♦ [Dice Chess](#) — Die roll constrains piece type
- ♦ [Displacement Chess](#) — Swap positions with adjacent friendly pieces
- ♦ [Duck Chess](#) — Place a blocker duck after each move
- ♦ [Einstein Chess](#) — Captures promote pieces, non-captures demote them
- ♦ [Extinction Chess](#) — Lose when any piece type is eliminated
- ♦ [Fischer Random](#) — 960 randomised starting positions
- ♦ [Fog of War](#) — Only see squares your pieces attack
- ♦ [Grid Chess](#) — Moves must cross a 2×2 grid line
- ♦ [Hoppel-Poppel](#) — Knights capture like bishops, bishops capture like knights
- ♦ [Horde Chess](#) — 36 pawns vs a normal army
- ♦ [Immunization Chess](#) — Captures make adjacent enemies immune for 2 turns
- ♦ [King of the Hill](#) — King reaches centre = instant win
- ♦ [Madrasi Chess](#) — Same-type opposing pieces paralyse each other
- ♦ [Maharaja & Sepoys](#) — One super-piece vs a full army
- ♦ [Marseillais](#) — Two moves per turn
- ♦ [Medusa Chess](#) — Queen petrifies enemy pieces she attacks
- ♦ [No Castling](#) — Standard chess, castling disabled
- ♦ [No Retreat](#) — Pieces cannot move backward
- ♦ [Patrol Chess](#) — Capture only when defended by a friendly piece
- ♦ [Poison Chess](#) — Capture squares become poisoned for 3 turns
- ♦ [Racing Kings](#) — No checks allowed, race King to rank 8
- ♦ [Recruitment Chess](#) — Captured pieces defect to the captor
- ♦ [Rifle Chess](#) — Capturing pieces stay on their square
- ♦ [Teleport Chess](#) — 3 teleports per game to any empty square

MULTI-MOVE VARIANTS

- ♦ [Monster Chess](#) — White gets 2 moves, Black gets 1
- ♦ [Progressive](#) — Escalating moves per turn (1, 2, 3, 4...)

ALTERNATIVE WIN CONDITIONS

- ♦ [Antichess](#) — Forced captures, lose all pieces to win
- ♦ [Codrus](#) — Lose your King to win, no check concept
- ♦ [Five-Check](#) — Five checks to win
- ♦ [Giveaway](#) — Forced captures, lose all pieces to win (stalemate = loss)
- ♦ [Omnicide](#) — Lose all pieces to win, captures NOT forced
- ♦ [Single-Check](#) — One check wins instantly
- ♦ [Stalemate Wins](#) — Stalemating your opponent wins
- ♦ [Suicide Chess](#) — Forced captures, lose all pieces to win (stalemate = draw)
- ♦ [Three-Check](#) — Deliver three checks to win

PIECE REPLACEMENT & MOVEMENT VARIANTS

- ♦ [Almost Chess](#) — One queen replaced by Chancellor (R+N)
- ♦ [Amazon Chess](#) — Queens replaced by Amazons (Q+N)
- ♦ [Berolina Chess](#) — Pawns move diagonally and capture straight (inverted)
- ♦ [Chigorin](#) — White has 4 knights instead of bishops
- ♦ [Knightmate](#) — Knight is royal, King moves like a knight
- ♦ [Orda Chess](#) — Asymmetric: White standard vs Black divergent movers

STARTING POSITION VARIANTS

- ♦ [Endgame Chess](#) — Only pawns and Kings from the start
- ♦ [Legan Chess](#) — Berolina pawns, King and Queen swap starting squares
- ♦ [Pawns Only](#) — Only pawns, first promotion wins
- ♦ [Peasants' Revolt](#) — King + pawns vs King + knights
- ♦ [Upside-Down](#) — Pieces start on opponent's rank

REGIONAL & HISTORICAL VARIANTS

- ♦ [Makpong](#) — Thai variant, King cannot move out of check
- ♦ [Makruk](#) — Thai chess, pawns promote on rank 6 to Met
- ♦ [Shatar](#) — Mongolian chess, win by baring the opponent's King
- ♦ [Shatranj](#) — Medieval Islamic chess, ancestor of modern chess
- ♦ [Sittuyin](#) — Burmese chess, placement opening phase

EXPANDED BOARDS

- ♦ [Capablanca Chess](#) — 10×8 with Archbishop + Chancellor
- ♦ [Courier Chess](#) — 12×8, medieval variant from 1202
- ♦ [Grand Chess](#) — 10×10, same new pieces, bigger stage

SMALL BOARDS

- ♦ [Breakthrough](#) — 7×7, pawns only, first to far rank wins
- ♦ [Diana Chess](#) — 6×6, no queens or knights
- ♦ [Half Chess](#) — 8×4, armies start adjacent
- ♦ [Los Alamos](#) — 6×6, no bishops, first computer chess (1956)
- ♦ [Minichess](#) — 5×5, full piece types on tiny board
- ♦ [Petty Chess](#) — 5×6, all piece types, single copies



Printed 23 June 2026

V0.4.4